



MONTHLY UPDATE

Benin: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-08 • 24 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • FINANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • TECHNOLOGY • CAPACITY • DATA

Summary of the month

The month's work was training and open government rather than new systems. The state information-systems agency [opened a certification cohort for 25 departmental information-security officers on 3 August](#), and the capital's town hall [opened an artificial-intelligence academy for 60 secondary pupils on 19 August](#). The budget directorate [published a 38-activity co-creation roadmap for the country's first Open Government Partnership action plan](#), eighteen months after accession and with the plan itself still unadopted.

Two working systems tightened. A university [made its academic-records platform the sole channel for those documents](#), and the cross-border identity work Benin does through Smart Africa [moved into a running pilot with Rwanda and Ghana](#). Against them the emergency response body [put ransomware detections in the country at 631 for 2024, on a security vendor's telemetry rather than its own](#), and a four-country comparative study [found no artificial-intelligence legislation here in force or in draft](#).

Governance

Data protection

Body-worn cameras have become standard kit for traffic police in the largest city, on the [500 devices and the dedicated information system the Council of Ministers authorised on 1 March 2023](#) for the police and customs, piloted from 2024 in three cities. What the record does not carry is the part that governs the footage: [who may view it, how long it is kept and whether a citizen can obtain their own sequence remain unstated](#). A collection authorised by decree and a retention rule published nowhere is the shape this ledger already holds for the data-protection layer generally.

The data-protection authority took its position abroad rather than issuing it at home. Its president told a fintech regulators' forum in Johannesburg that [trust, cooperation between regulators and coordination with financial authorities are what secure the growth of artificial intelligence and cross-border data flows](#). It is a set of recommendations rather than an instrument, and no bilateral or regional arrangement follows from it on the record.

Regional collaboration

The cross-border digital identity work Benin does through Smart Africa moved from development into a running pilot: [an identity issued in one of Rwanda, Ghana or Benin is now being recognised in the other two](#), with eighteen further countries said to be joining and no date given for any of them.

Standards

Benin's standards body is now inside the international system rather than beside it: the Agence Nationale de Normalisation [is recorded as a full member of ISO](#), having [launched the national NB conformity mark in April](#). Membership is a standing on paper; what the base does not hold is a standards catalogue, a certified-product count, or any ICT-specific Beninese standard.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Internet governance was taught rather than legislated. A school on the subject [was held in Ouidah with human rights at the centre of its programme](#). It is a training event; the record held names no policy process it feeds into.

Finance

New investments

One commitment entered the window. During a ministerial visit of 4 to 6 August, Canada [announced CAD5m for the digital transformation of women-led businesses, one of seven projects in a package of about CAD17m for Benin and West Africa](#). The remaining six lines are outside the digital estate. What the digital line does not carry is an implementing partner, a start date or a duration, so there is nothing yet to follow from the announcement to a system.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The regulator published a competitive ranking. Its weekly readings [placed the state-linked operator Celtiis ahead of MTN and Moov Africa on 3G and 4G data speed](#). The measurement is the regulator's own, the ordering rather than the absolute speeds is what it publishes, and the state's interest in one of the three operators is worth holding in mind while reading it.

Cybersecurity

The month's one figure for how exposed the country is came from a vendor rather than the state. In a national newspaper interview the head of the computer emergency response body [cited 631 ransomware threats detected in Benin in 2024, on security-vendor telemetry reported through Interpol's Africa assessment](#), attributing the rise to fast adoption outrunning security practice and to a criminal market where access and tooling can be rented rather than built. How much of the national estate that vendor sees is unpublished, so the count is not a measure of national exposure, and no incident, ransom-payment or recovery figure stands beside it.

DPI

Data Exchange

The exchange [recorded more than 138 million requests in total](#), 32.7m in the preceding thirty days, across 73 members, 176 information systems and 512 services.

A second kind of data exchange entered the record in August, and it is regional rather than national. The BIC-UEMOA credit information bureau held its first Cotonou data forum on 23 July, [reported on 13 August](#), with the finance ministry framing data quality as the route to cutting credit-approval turnaround to 48 hours. The bureau

spans all eight union states with 321 data providers, about 48 million contracts and more than 20 million active borrowers. The figures are the operator's own and union-wide; nothing Benin-specific — coverage, dispute rate or the data-protection basis for the file — is held.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The identity agency wants to analyse what it holds. It [opened a tender for the architecture of a business-intelligence environment over its national identity data](#). Analytics over a population register raises the question of what the analysis is for and who may run it; the tender notice in the record held does not answer either, and no purpose limitation is stated.

Registries

One commune is now completely mapped, and the map shows who the register cannot see. Parakou [became the first commune with complete cadastral coverage, 196,474 parcels across about 56,390 hectares, presented to a Netherlands embassy delegation on 1 September, with more than 11,500 cadastral registration certificates distributed door to door](#). The ownership breakdown is the part worth carrying: [38 per cent of registered parcels are in men's ownership against 7 per cent women's and 3 per cent collectivites, and the owners of 21 per cent cannot be identified at all, with no parcel recorded as contested](#).

Sectoral management information systems

The tax directorate's information-system modernisation surfaced in the window only because its funder republished the project sheet. The EUR 2m project [runs from 9 August 2023 to 31 December 2026](#), which puts it four months from its stated end. What the sheet does not carry is any statement of what has been delivered — no module, no milestone, no completion status — so the base can date the project and price it, and cannot say whether it is finishing or merely ending.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The University of Abomey-Calavi [made its ACTIA platform the sole channel for academic records, by a rectorate note of 31 July 2026](#). Closing the counter is what makes a platform load-bearing, and it is also the point at which anyone unable to use it stops being served; no alternative route for that case is stated.

Technology

AI

A [four-country comparative study presented on 10 August found no AI-specific legislation in force or in draft in Benin](#), which leaves the 2023-2027 national strategy carrying the field on its own. The same study rates Cote d'Ivoire's strategy the most advanced of the four on inclusion and data governance, and finds Burkina Faso's data-protection law the only one of the four to name AI-based processing explicitly.

Capacity

Training and skills

Two cohorts opened in the month, both small and both institutional. The state information-systems agency [began a certification programme for 25 departmental information-security officers on 3 August](#), and the capital's town hall [opened an artificial-intelligence academy for 60 secondary pupils on 19 August](#), framed on urban problems. Neither publishes a curriculum, a completion standard or a plan for a second cohort.

Data

Open data

The Open Government Partnership action plan's co-creation opened this month, eighteen months after the country joined. The budget directorate published a [38-activity co-creation matrix](#) naming for each step the responsible body, its partners, the funding source and an indicative deadline, running from the June 2025 ministerial order that established the national committee through preparation, departmental consultation and adoption to documentation of the process after December 2026, with activity 32 committing government to publish a what-was-heard, what-was-kept-and-why report alongside a matrix of reasoned responses. The plan itself is not adopted, and no consultation record or commitment text is published.

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